

Ralf Lauwers

IT Project, Program, Portfolio & PMO Manager

Contact Information

E-mail: ralf.lauwers@gmail.com

Mobile: +32 497 302 151

Professional Summary

I am a **Senior IT Project, Program, Portfolio & PMO Manager** with **20+ years of experience** delivering complex IT initiatives across **Logistics, Government, Pharma, Telecom, and Banking**. I specialize in **large-scale infrastructure, cloud, and digital transformation programs**, aligning IT delivery with business strategy in **regulated, mission-critical environments**.

Throughout my career, I have led **multi-million-euro programs**, coordinated cross-functional and vendor teams, and established **robust governance and portfolio frameworks**. My expertise spans **infrastructure modernization, ERP implementations, cloud adoption, and PMO setup**, always with a focus on measurable business outcomes, risk reduction, and operational excellence.

I am particularly effective in environments that require **clarity, structure, and stakeholder trust**. Whether working with **executive sponsors, CIOs**, architects, or external partners, I bring a **structured, transparent leadership style** that ensures alignment across technical and non-technical teams.

Hands-on, pragmatic, and people-centric, I balance governance with agility, discipline with flexibility, and strategy with execution. Curiosity, organization, and a sense of humor drive how I lead and collaborate.

Currently open to IT Project/Program Manager, IT Portfolio Manager or IT PMO Manager opportunities where transformation, governance, and strategic alignment matter.

Experience (most recent)

Project Implementation Manager & Team Lead – ITS Moving

Gosselin Group · Freelance | Sep 2025 – Present · Antwerp, Belgium

Reporting to: **CIO**

Led IT project and program delivery for the Moving division, aligning infrastructure and ERP initiatives with business priorities in an international logistics environment.

Established and operationalized an IT PMO, based on Prince2 and Agile methodologies, defining governance, delivery standards, reporting structures, and portfolio visibility to improve decision-making and execution control.

Managed ERP vendor relationships, overseeing planning, execution, and performance to ensure alignment with contractual and business expectations.

Acted as a core member of the strategic management team, reporting directly to the CIO and supporting IT investment prioritization, roadmap planning, and risk management.

Built and led a multidisciplinary IT team, improving collaboration, accountability, and delivery predictability across projects and initiatives.

Program Manager / Senior Project Manager IT Infrastructure

CM – Christelijke Mutualiteit · Freelance | Nov 2023 – May 2025 · Brussels, Belgium

Reporting to: **Service Delivery Manager & BU Managers**

Budget: 4.500K€

Led a multi-stream IT infrastructure program, including network, security, and telephony projects, utilizing Prince2 and Agile methodologies to deliver projects on time and within budget, supporting mission-critical services across 300+ offices..

Directed a major data center network upgrade and office network switch/Wi-Fi refresh initiatives, coordinating vendors and internal teams to minimize disruption.

Defined and maintained the Infrastructure Program Roadmap, enabling structured investment planning, prioritization, and visibility of future initiatives.

Managed risks, dependencies, and governance, improving execution predictability and alignment with organizational priorities.

Facilitated stakeholder engagement, ensuring cross-functional collaboration and alignment with IT strategy.

Program / Project Manager Digitization for the Cloud Center of Excellence

Umicore · Freelance | Feb 2023 – Nov 2023 · Antwerp, Belgium

Reporting to: **CCoE Manager**

Led enterprise cloud programs across IT and Business Units, supporting digital transformation initiatives.

Defined cloud governance, KPIs, and delivery standards to ensure consistent and controlled cloud adoption.

Managed cross-functional and international teams, coordinating IT, security, architecture, and business stakeholders.

Oversaw SaaS and IaaS implementations, improving platform agility and aligning with security, cost, and operational requirements.

Enabled business-led innovation through cloud platforms, accelerating time-to-delivery and strengthening IT–business alignment.

Program Manager Finance Transformation

PwC Belgium · Freelance | Sep 2022 – Feb 2023 · Brussels, Belgium

Reporting to: **CIO & Portfolio Manager & PMO**

Led Finance Transformation program, impacting 50+ finance professionals, coordinating multiple initiatives to modernize finance operations and delivery models.

Drove digital transformation initiatives, streamlining processes, improving efficiency, and enhancing reporting transparency.

Implemented finance systems and automation tools, enabling cost control and data-driven decision-making.

Established program governance, ensuring alignment between finance leadership, IT, and business objectives.

Facilitated stakeholder engagement and change adoption, enabling smooth transitions to new operating models.

Program/Project Manager IT Transformation, Interim Product Owner & Scrum Master, Interim Team Lead Infrastructure & Operations (8 FTE), Interim Team Lead Enterprise Architects (4 FTE), Client Transition Manager for a Managed Service Provider (MSP)

Coreso SA · Freelance | Jul 2021 – Jul 2022 · Brussels, Belgium

Reporting to: **CIO & PMO**

Budget: 5.600K€

- **Led IT Transformation Program**, coordinating 12 engineers to deliver enterprise modernization initiatives.
- **Directed MSP client transition**, ensuring seamless handover while maintaining service continuity.
- **Established program governance**, KPIs, and reporting frameworks for transparency and alignment with strategy.
- **Implemented cloud and infrastructure solutions**, improving efficiency and scalability.
- **Facilitated stakeholder alignment**, bridging IT and business needs to ensure adoption and measurable results.

EMEA IT Infrastructure Project Manager

Johnson & Johnson · Freelance | Jul 2019 – Dec 2019 · Beerse, Belgium

Reporting to: **PMO**

Budget: 9.200K€

- **Directed replacement of CISCO-based network and security infrastructure** across 37 sites in 13 EMEA countries, minimizing disruption and meeting timelines.
- **Developed and executed transition plans**, including risk mitigation and vendor coordination.
- **Implemented modernized network and security solutions**, enhancing connectivity, reliability, and security posture.
- **Managed project governance and budget tracking**, providing leadership with clear reporting and metrics.

- **Facilitated international collaboration**, coordinating IT teams, local site managers, and vendors to ensure consistent standards.

Current Passions

- Information Technology (Cloud / On-Prem / Hybrid)
- Strategic Portfolio Management & PMO
- Using AI in Project/Program Management
- Infrastructure & ERP Digital Transformations

Education

- Practical Application of Generative AI for Project Managers (PMI)
- Data Landscape of GenAI for Project Managers (PMI)
- Talking to AI: Prompt Engineering for Project Managers (PMI)
- Generative AI Mastermind (Outskill)
- Master's Degree, Electrical, Electronics and Communications Engineering (Thomas More)
- Master's Certificate in Project Management (PMP)
- Master in Business Administration (self-study)
- Portfolio & Program Management (self-study)
- Data Center Consolidation (HPE)
- Microsoft Certified System Engineer Internet (MCSE+I)
- Software Development in Defense Systems (FMC)
- Operational IT Management (HPE)
- Solution Definition and Creation (HPE)
- Business Process Re-engineering (Alcatel)
- Sales & Business Negotiations (Alcatel)

Industries of experience

Logistics, Government, Pharma, Telecom, Banking, IT services & Consulting, Real-estate & building, Insurance

Customers

Gosselin Group, CM Belgium, Umicore, PwC, Coreso SA, Johnson & Johnson, KBC, ING, Centea, Proximus, Orange (NL), Vandemoortele, FOD Finance, ERGO (Norway), Electrabel, BBTK, AIB Vincotte, Eurocontrol, Pfizer, Acerta, LCM, KONE, HP Consulting (BE, NL, UK, NO, USA), Alcatel Telecom, FMC Corporation (USA)

Spoken Languages

- English (fluent)
- Dutch (native speaker)
- German (good understanding)
- French (basic understanding)

Skills

1. IT Program Management
2. IT Portfolio Management
3. PMO Management
4. Program Governance
5. Project Governance
6. Project Planning
7. Project Scheduling
8. Risk Management
9. Stakeholder Management
10. Vendor Management
11. Change Management
12. PMI, PMP, Prince2 Methodology
13. Agile Project Management
14. IT Project Lifecycle
15. Resource Planning
16. Program Roadmapping
17. KPIs & Metrics Management
18. Delivery Management
19. IT Infrastructure Management
20. Cloud Programs (Azure / AWS / SaaS / IaaS)
21. Network & Security Infrastructure
22. ERP Systems Implementation
23. IT Transformation
24. MSP / Vendor Transition
25. IT Operations & Governance
26. Digital Transformation
27. Business-IT Alignment
28. Finance Transformation Programs
29. Regulated Industry Compliance
30. Cross-Functional Leadership
31. Multi-Cultural Team Leadership
32. Executive Reporting & Steering Committees
33. Planview Enterprise
34. PMBOK / Standard Frameworks
35. IT Budget & Cost Management
36. Program KPI Dashboards
37. Portfolio Reporting & Metrics
38. Risk & Dependency Management
39. Delivery & Change Management